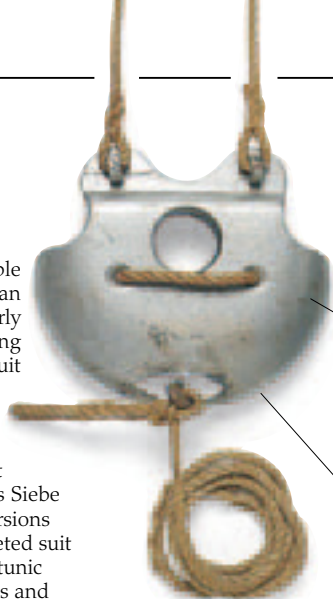




Example of an early diving suit

A CLASSIC DIVING SUIT

The "Standard" diving suit was invented by Augustus Siebe in the 1830s. Modified versions of this classic, hard-helmeted suit are still in use today. The tunic is made of layers of canvas and rubber so that it is hard-wearing and waterproof. The copper and brass helmet fits onto a heavy breast-plate (corselet) that is bolted onto the tunic. The diver wore leather boots with heavy lead bases and two additional weights. It would take about half an hour to get suited up in all this gear. Then the diver would sink to depths of about 200 ft (60 m).



Weight is about 30 lb (13 kg)

Diver has two weights—one at the front, a second at the back

Helmet equipped with two-way communication system so diver can talk to someone on the surface



Helmet made of copper and brass

Face plate

Spanner for tightening bolts on breastplate

Breastplate screwed to tunic using six, eight, or twelve bolts

Longjohns made from wool for greater warmth and insulation



Ribbed cuff helps trap warm air

Leather boot with lead base to help weigh down diver in water



Each boot weighs 18 lb (8 kg)

Complete "Standard" diving suit

Rubber cuff for extra waterproofing

Suit made of a layer of rubber between two layers of canvas